MODULE 4

Techniques of Police & Investigation Agencies

Certified Cyber Criminologist - Police / LEA Training

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What You Will Learn

In cybercrime, **speed plus procedure** beats everything. This module gives you both: the tools that act fast and the law that makes them stick.

- **Portals that start every case** - cybercrime.gov.in and the 1930 helpline, used correctly
- **CDR, IPDR and tower dumps** - the three technical pillars that reveal the criminal's network
- **BNSS Section 94 notices** - getting records legally from banks and telecom companies
- **Zero FIR and case diary** - rights of the victim and the discipline of the investigator

The 2 AM Scenario

It is 2 AM. A fraudster has cheated an elderly person of **Rs 5 lakh**. The money has moved through **three bank accounts** already. By morning it leaves the fourth.

- You have one weapon: **speed** - and speed comes from knowing the right technique in advance
- Which portal to hit, which notice to send, which record to ask for, and **in what order**
- The officer who knows this stays **two steps ahead** of the criminal. This module makes you that officer

Working with LEAs: Two Rules

LEA means **Law Enforcement Agencies** - state police, cyber cells, CBI, central agencies. Two rules govern working with them.

- **Rule 1 - Respect jurisdiction:** local police do the initial investigation; big or inter-state cases go to the cyber cell or CBI
- **Rule 2 - Use the correct channel:** a WhatsApp tip is not a formal complaint. Serious information goes **in writing**, to the right officer
- Private investigators: your relationship with LEAs is **cooperation, not conflict** - only police can arrest or seize
- Know every agency's role **before** the emergency - there is no time to learn during one

cybercrime.gov.in: The National Portal

India's **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal** - where most cyber investigations officially begin.

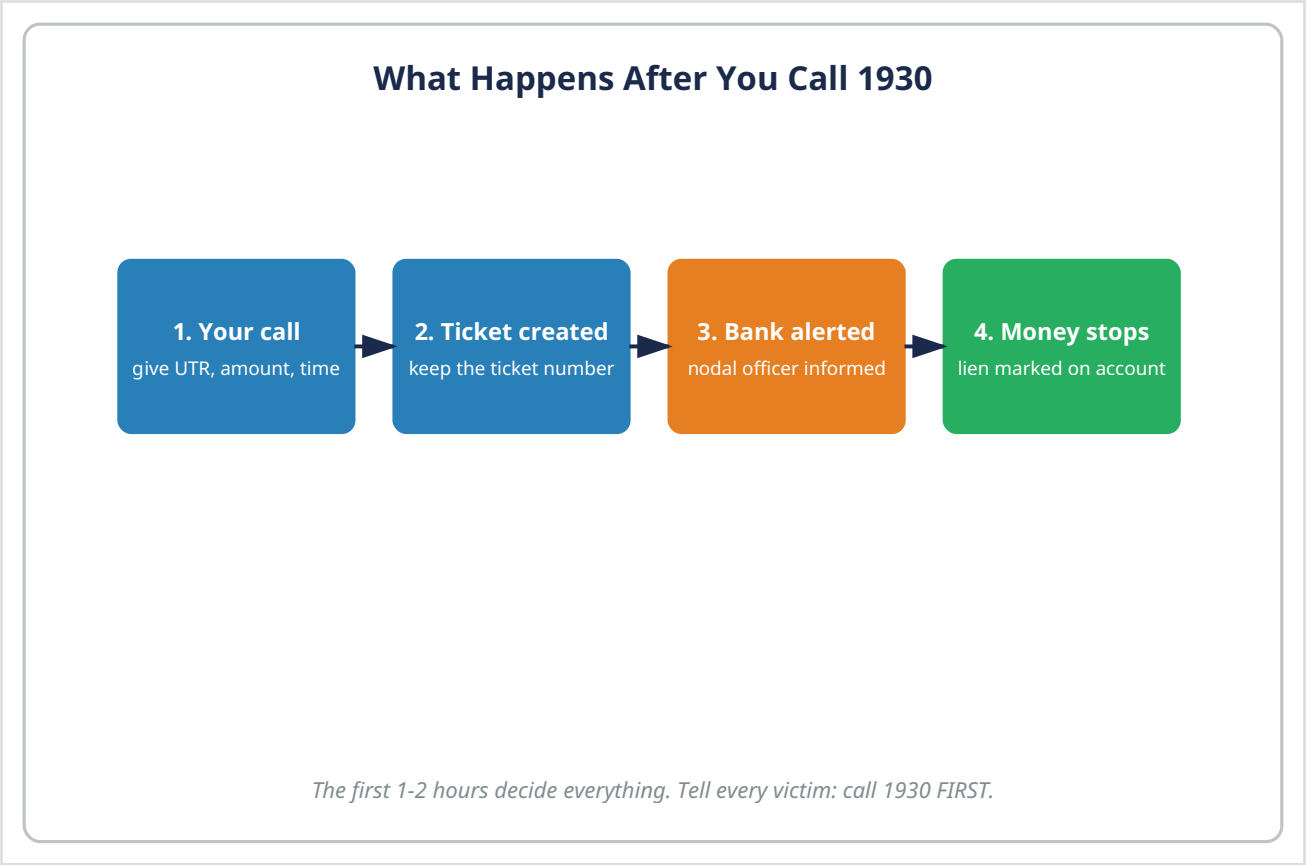
- Anyone can file a complaint online. Crimes against **women and children** have a special section - complaint possible **even without a name**
- The form has four sections: **complainant details, incident details, suspect details, evidence upload**
- Golden rule: write the incident in **correct order**, with **exact date, time and amount** - jumbled complaints slow everything
- Upload evidence **clear and original** - blurred screenshots are useless to the investigator

1930: The Helpline That Freezes Money

The **national helpline for cyber fraud**, run by I4C under the Ministry of Home Affairs. One call can **stop stolen money**.

- Call it the **moment** money fraud happens - not tomorrow, not after 'thinking about it'
- I4C's control room immediately alerts the bank's **nodal officer**, who puts a hold (lien) on the receiving account
- If the fraudster has not forwarded the money yet, it **stops right there** - recoverable later through legal process
- The **first one to two hours** are everything. Fraudsters move money between accounts in minutes

What Happens After You Call 1930



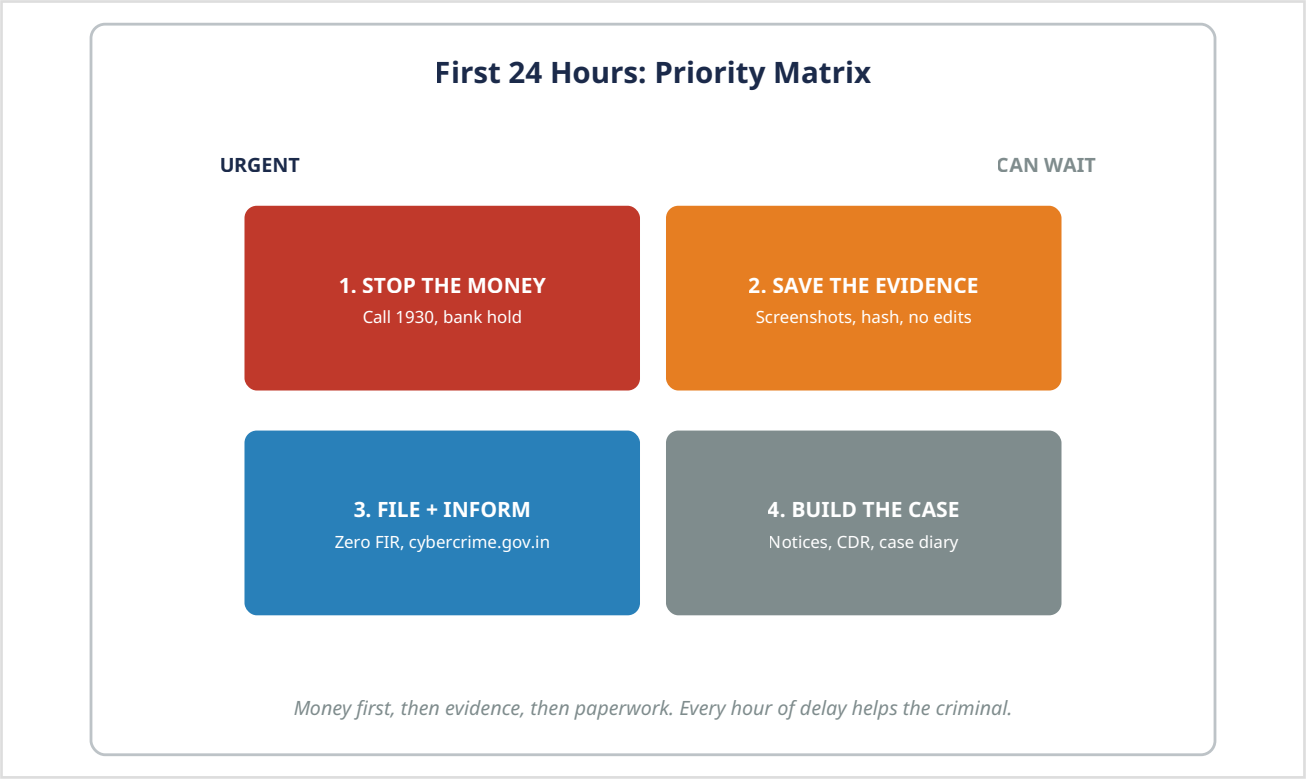
- Your call creates a **ticket number** - keep it safe; it is your reference for every follow-up
- Tell the victim the **first advice is always**: call 1930 first, everything else later

Before You Call 1930: Keep This Ready

The operator will ask for specifics. **Write them on paper before dialling** - panic makes people forget.

- **What happened** - in one or two clear sentences. What the fraudster said or sent
- **How much money** went, **when** it went (exact time), and **to which number or UPI ID**
- The **transaction ID / UTR number** - from your bank SMS, app, or statement. This is the money's fingerprint
- Your **correct contact details** - the investigator may need to reach you. A wrong number stalls the case

First 24 Hours: The Priority Matrix



- Not everything is equally urgent. **Stop the money first**, preserve evidence second, paperwork third
- Write this priority order on **page one of your diary** - in a real case there is no time to think

First 24 Hours: The Full Checklist

Seven actions, in order. The investigating officer who completes these in 24 hours has a **strong case**.

- **1. Call 1930** immediately - stopping the money is priority one. **2. Preserve all evidence** - screenshots, chats, receipts, unedited
- **3. Note the transaction ID** (UTR), amount, date, time. **4. File on cybercrime.gov.in** - keep the ticket number safe
- **5. File the FIR** - remember Zero FIR, no station can refuse. **6. Inform your bank in writing** - email or branch
- **7. Send BNSS s.94 notices early** - companies delete old data within months. Late means no evidence at all

CDR, IPDR, Tower Dumps: Three Pillars

Record	What it shows	What it gets you
CDR Call Detail Record	Who called whom, when, for how long	The criminal's **network**
IPDR Internet Protocol Detail Record	Which IP went to which device, when	The criminal's **online trail**
Tower dump	All numbers on one tower at one time	**Suspicious numbers** in an area

Reading a CDR Like a Detective

A CDR is a table of calls. Three questions turn it into a **map of the gang**:

- **Who talks the most?** The number appearing in the most rows is the hub - the centre of the network
- **Who is active at night?** Long calls between 11 PM and 4 AM are not normal life - they are planning
- **Who connects whom?** A number calling two separate groups is the **bridge** - often the coordinator
- In real cases there are thousands of rows - but the **method never changes**

Tower Dumps: Catching Numbers by Location

When you know **where and when** the crime happened, the tower dump tells you **who was there**.

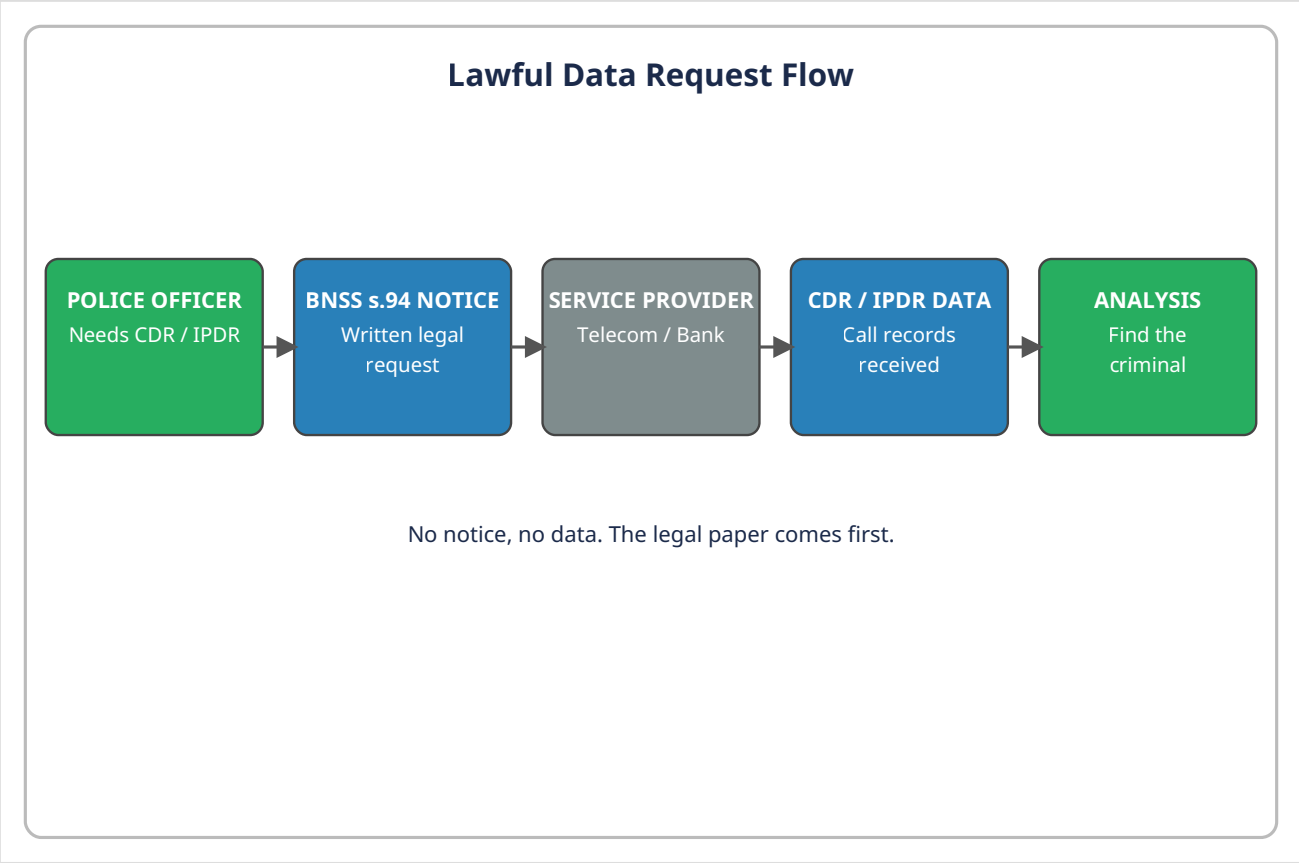
- The police get the list of **all numbers** connected to that area's tower at that time - from the telecom company
- Then the filtering begins: remove regular local numbers, keep the **outsiders and the suspicious**
- A number that appears at **multiple crime locations** on different dates is gold - the criminal carries his phone everywhere
- Like CDR, tower dumps come only through **legal notice** - never informally

BNSS Section 94: The Notice That Opens Records

Banks and telecom companies **do not hand over data on request**. They hand it over on a **legal notice** - and the correct section is everything.

- Under **Section 94 of the BNSS** (Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita), police can demand any document or record needed for investigation
- This replaced the old **Section 91 CrPC** in July 2024. The power is the same; the **number changed**
- Without this notice: no CDR, no bank statement, no customer details. The company will - and must - refuse
- Only an **authorised police officer** can send it. Private investigators cannot

How a Section 94 Notice Travels



- Write **what** you need, **which case and section**, **which period** - and a clear deadline
- An incomplete demand gets **incomplete** information - precision is power

Anatomy of a Good Notice

Five things must be in every notice. Miss one, and the company **can legally delay or refuse**.

- **1. Sender:** police station, your rank, district, phone and email - so they know it is genuine
- **2. Case reference:** case number and sections - without it, no company shares data
- **3. Exact demand:** not 'give CDR' but 'CDR of 98XXXXXXXX from 01-01-2025 to 31-03-2025'
- **4. Deadline:** 'within 7 days of receipt' - without a date, replies hang forever.

  5. Signature and seal

New Law: Forget 91 CrPC

Old law	New law (from July 2024)
Section 91 CrPC - demand documents	**Section 94 BNSS** - demand documents
Section 92 CrPC - postal/telegraph	Covered under **BNSS** provisions
Indian Evidence Act	**BSA** - Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam
IPC	**BNS** - Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita

The 91 CrPC Mistake: Still Happening

Officers are **still sending notices citing 91 CrPC**. In court, that single line can sink your notice.

- The defence asks: 'Under which law was this record obtained?' - the **wrong section weakens your answer**
- A notice's validity can be questioned if it cites a **repealed law**. Do not give them that gift
- Update your templates **today**: BNS for offences, BNSS s.94 for record demands, BSA for evidence
- Knowing the new law is not trivia - it is **professional survival**

Zero FIR: No One Can Be Turned Away



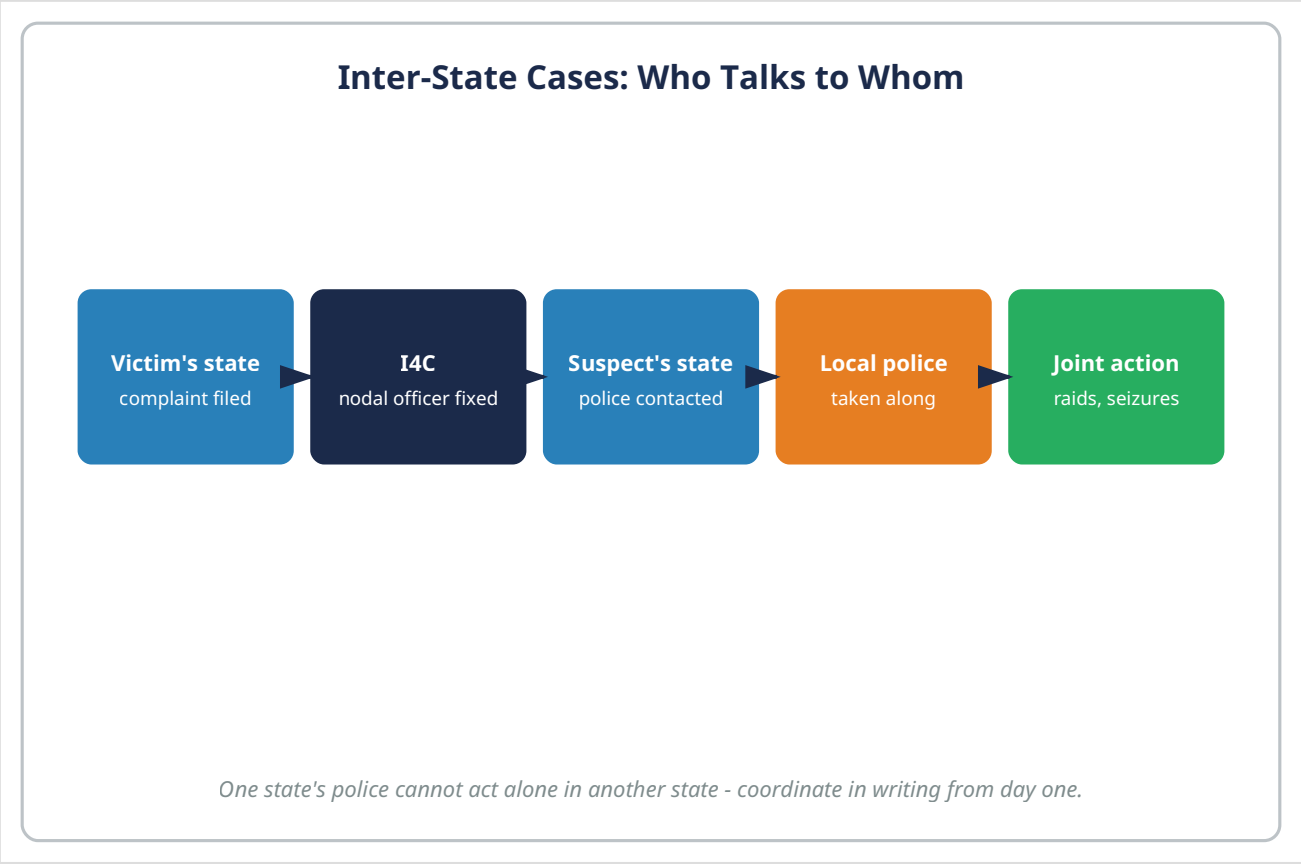
- Crime happened elsewhere? FIR is still filed - **zero number**, then transferred
- **e-FIR:** many states allow online filing; a cybercrime.gov.in complaint works like one
- Always **take a copy** - it is the victim's right

Drafting an FIR: Five Essentials

A weak FIR cripples the investigation before it starts. These **five things must be in it**:

- **Date and time** of the incident - exact, from call logs or messages, never guessed
- **Place or platform** - where it happened, or which app, website or number was used
- **What happened** - in clear words, in correct order. First this, then that
- **Amount of loss** - exact. Exaggeration creates problems later; understatement weakens the case

Inter-State Cases: Think Map First



- **Map from day one:** victim's state, suspect's state, bank's state, server location
- One state's police **cannot act alone** elsewhere - local police come along
- Share everything via the nodal officer - **holding back weakens the case**

Coordination in Five Steps

Cybercrime ignores state borders. Your investigation must **cross them legally**:

- **Step 1 - Map:** write down every state the case touches - victim, number, account, server
- **Step 2 - Nodal officer:** in big cases one officer coordinates all states. I4C helps fix this
- **Step 3 - Written requests:** start on phone if urgent, but the **formal request is always in writing**
- **Step 4 - Local police along:** for any action in another state. Build these contacts **before** you need them

MLAT: When the Criminal Is Abroad

MLAT - Mutual Legal Assistance Treaty - is how one country legally asks another for evidence. Slow, but sure.

- Cybercrime is routinely cross-border: server in the US, criminal in Nigeria, victim in India - **this is normal**
- **Why slow:** diplomatic channels, two legal systems, translations - it takes **months**
- So try **faster routes first**: direct legal requests to the company, Interpol channels
- But know MLAT cold - in serious cases it is the **last and surest route**

I4C, CERT-In, Cyber Cells: Who Does What

Three names you will hear constantly. Know **exactly which door to knock** for what:

- **I4C** (Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre, MHA) - runs the **1930 helpline**, coordinates states, runs the Cyber Volunteer programme
- **CERT-In** (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team) - handles **big cyber attacks** on critical systems
- **Cyber Crime Cells** - every district or range has one. The **main investigation** of cybercrime happens here
- Keep a **contact list** of all three plus bank nodal officers. In an emergency there is no time to Google

Handling Digital Evidence: Five Basics

Module 2 covered seizure in depth. These five basics apply to **every digital item** you touch in any case:

- **Do not change the original** - analyse the copy, never the original file or screenshot
- **Screenshots must show date and time** - the phone's status bar proves when it was taken
- **Take full context** - export the whole chat, not two messages. Half a story misleads
- **Extract and note the hash** - SHA-256 proves the file was never changed.
  Label everything - what, when, from whom

Common Mistakes That Weaken Cases

Even experienced officers make these. **Know them so you never repeat them**:

- **Late complaint** - 'we will see tomorrow' lets the fraudster withdraw everything. Hours matter
- **Editing evidence** - cropping a screenshot or hiding chat parts invites the question: what was hidden?
- **Calling the criminal yourself** - to 'gather evidence'. He switches off, erases all, vanishes
- **Wrong-station runaround** - accepting 'not our area'. Zero FIR exists - **use it**. **Old section on notices** - write 94 BNSS, not 91 CrPC

The Case Diary: Your Daily Record

Under the BNSS, the investigating officer **must** maintain a case diary. Months later, **your diary speaks in court** - your memory does not.

- **Every action with date and time:** '15-04-2025, 10:00 AM - BNSS s.94 notice sent to the bank'
- **Every evidence received:** what it is, where from, in what condition
- **Witness conversations** - summarised truthfully. **Next plan** - what happens tomorrow
- Write **only the truth**: what you did, not guesses. Never write what you did not do

Real Case: Operation Chakra-III (2024)

In June 2024, the CBI ran **synchronised raids across multiple states** against cyber-fraud networks.

- State police and central agencies worked as **one team** - CDR, bank records and digital evidence connected across borders
- The operation proved that **coordination wins**: shared records, a common plan, simultaneous action
- **Lesson:** in inter-state cybercrime, the agency that shares information fastest wins. Silos lose
- Source Press Information Bureau

Real Case: AIIMS Delhi Ransomware (2022)

November 2022 - ransomware encrypted servers at **India's top hospital**. Patient care ran on paper for weeks.

- **CERT-In and investigating agencies worked together** - server logs and network records became the key evidence
- The case showed cybercrime is not only about money - it is **public safety and national security**
- **Lesson:** in critical-infrastructure attacks, preserve **logs immediately** and bring CERT-In in early
- Source The Hindu

Your Turn: Labs in This Module

LEA techniques are learned **by doing**. Chapter 4 has four hands-on labs:

- **Lab 1:** Walk through cybercrime.gov.in - read every section of the form. Do **NOT** press submit
- **Lab 2:** Draft a BNSS s.94 notice - case number, exact demand, period, deadline, signature and seal
- **Lab 3:** Analyse a sample CDR table - find the hub number and the night-activity pattern
- **Lab 4:** Draft a mock Zero FIR - date, time, place, amount, suspect info, all five essentials

Key Takeaways

- **1930 first, always** - money moves in minutes; your first hour decides the case
- **CDR, IPDR, tower dumps** - obtain them legally through notice, and obtain them early
- The law is now **BNS, BNSS, BSA** - record demands cite **Section 94 BNSS**, never 91 CrPC
- **Zero FIR** - no police station can turn a victim away. Take a copy, it is a right
- Coordinate **in writing** across states; try fast routes before MLAT
- Write your **case diary daily** - it is the witness that never forgets

Review Questions

- 1. It is 2 AM and Rs 5 lakh has just been defrauded. List your actions for the next 3 hours in exact order, with reasons.
- 2. A bank's nodal officer delays your CDR request for three weeks. What legal and practical steps do you take?
- 3. Draft the 'exact demand' paragraph of a BNSS s.94 notice for a UPI fraud case. What happens if you write it vaguely?
- 4. A victim's case spans Maharashtra (victim), Jharkhand (number) and Delhi (server). Design your coordination plan.
- 5. Your notice cited 91 CrPC and the defence challenges it. Argue why it still holds - and explain what you will do differently next time.

NEXT: MODULE 5

Cyber Laws: IT Act, BNS & DPDP

Sections every investigator must know by heart